

Content Outline / Blueprint

Digital Literacy Fundamentals — Course Architecture & Sequencing Logic

1. Course Context

Digital Literacy Fundamentals is a standalone course, the first in a planned digital-literacy sequence. Email and video-call (Zoom) skills are separate, later courses in that sequence and are out of scope here. This course has six lessons: five short teaching lessons (Orientation, Mouse, Keyboard, Windows, Desktop) followed by one capstone — a hands-on simulated practice environment applying everything taught in Lessons 2–5.

2. Sequencing Logic

Lesson	Content Block	Builds On	Enables
1	Orientation — what a laptop is, why this course exists, tied to a concrete learner goal	Nothing (entry point)	Establishes relevance and motivation before any skill content begins, per Andragogy's relevance principle
2	The Mouse — click, double-click, right-click, drag	Lesson 1	Single-click concept, which every later lesson's skills depend on per the Task & Content Analysis prerequisite hierarchy
3	The Keyboard — typing, Backspace, Enter, Shift	Lesson 1 (does not depend on Lesson 2 — keyboard and mouse skills are independent domains)	Basic text entry, needed for the capstone's typing task
4	Windows — open, close, minimize, switch	Lesson 2 (window controls are operated via click)	The window-as-space and minimize/restore concepts that Lesson 5's taskbar concept depends on
5	The Desktop — icons, taskbar	Lessons 2 and 4 (icon recognition depends on click; taskbar depends on minimize/restore)	The full conceptual vocabulary needed to attempt the capstone independently
6	Capstone — simulated practice environment	Lessons 2–5, all of them	Course completion — no further lesson follows

3. Why This Order, Not Topic Grouping

This sequence is fixed by the prerequisite hierarchy in the Task & Content Analysis, not by an intuitive topic order. Two decisions are worth calling out explicitly because they're not obvious from a topic-only view of the content:

Keyboard (Lesson 3) is placed after Mouse (Lesson 2) but doesn't actually depend on it — keyboard and mouse are independent skill domains. It's sequenced there because Lesson 1's orientation naturally introduces the laptop as a whole device, and covering both primary input methods (mouse, then keyboard) before moving to windows and

desktop concepts keeps the course's early lessons focused on direct physical input, with the more conceptual/spatial lessons (Windows, Desktop) following once the learner has some hands-on vocabulary already.

Desktop (Lesson 5) is placed last among the teaching lessons specifically because its taskbar concept has no instructional value until the learner has experienced the problem it solves — losing track of a window after minimizing it, taught in Lesson 4. Teaching the taskbar before Windows would mean explaining a solution to a problem the learner hasn't encountered yet.

4. Estimated Pacing

Lesson	Est. Time	Pacing Note
1 — Orientation	2–3 min	Short by design — motivation and framing, not content density.
2 — The Mouse	5–7 min	Includes discrimination practice (single vs. double-click) and a guided drag demonstration.
3 — The Keyboard	5–7 min	Includes a seeded-mistake correction exercise for Backspace.
4 — Windows	5–7 min	Includes a minimize/restore demonstration specifically designed to correct the “minimized means deleted” misconception.
5 — The Desktop	3–5 min	Shortest teaching lesson — both concepts (icons, taskbar) build directly on skills just practiced in Lessons 2 and 4.
6 — Capstone	10–15 min	Untimed by design. Learner completes a short multi-step task sequence independently, with real-laptop-equivalent labeling available on request throughout.

Total estimated time: 30–45 minutes, though the course is explicitly untimed and self-paced — these are planning estimates for facility scheduling purposes, not targets communicated to the learner.

5. Dependencies Outside This Course

None. This is a deliberate contrast with the writing course in this portfolio, where two activities depended on pen-and-paper work outside the platform. Digital Literacy Fundamentals is entirely self-contained — every skill taught is also the skill being practiced, inside the same environment, with nothing handed off to an outside tool or medium.